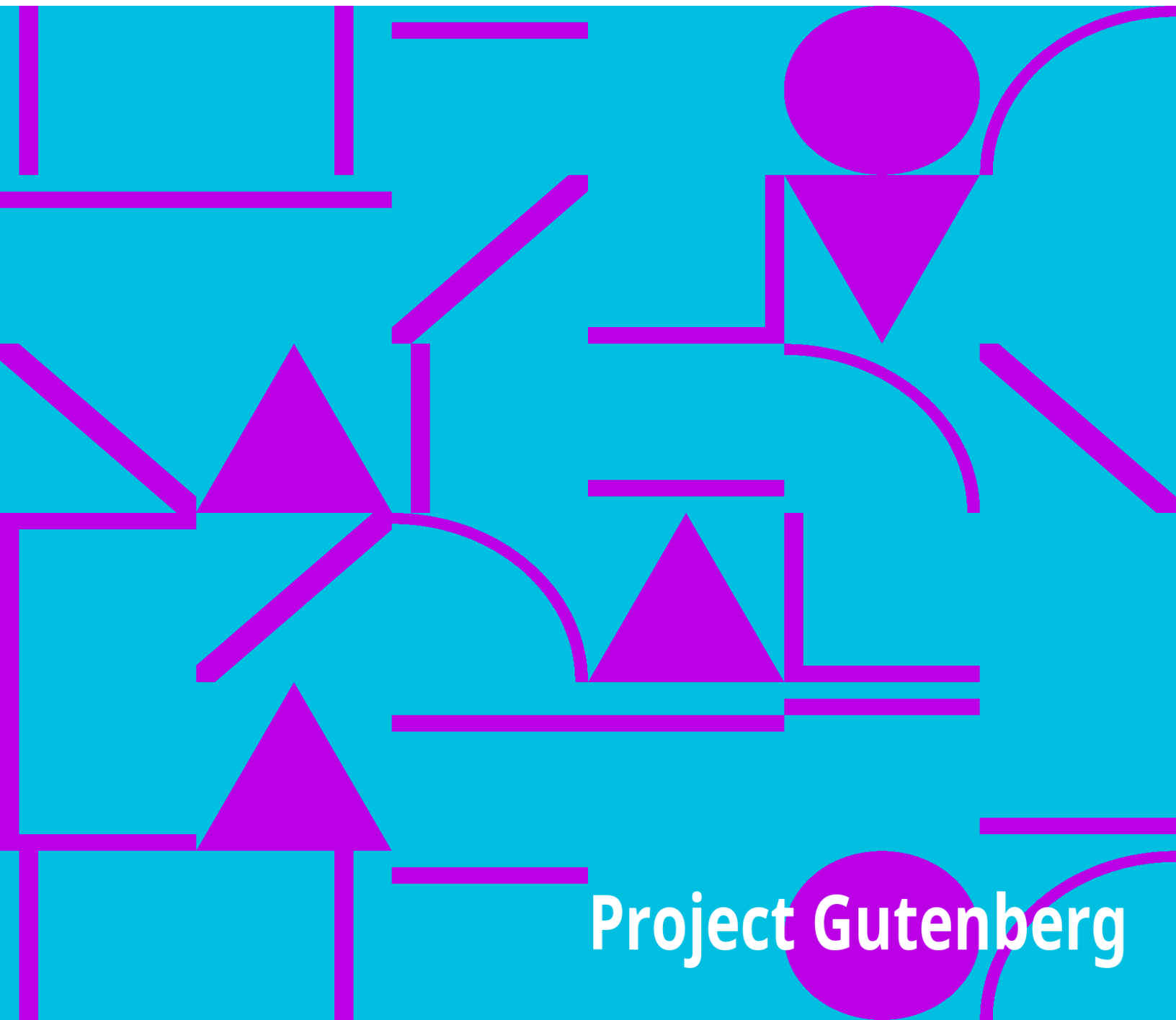


The Queen's Matrimonial Ladder

William Hone

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An abstract geometric pattern composed of various shapes including circles, triangles, squares, and lines in shades of blue, green, and yellow, set against a black background.

The Queen's Matrimonial Ladder

William Hone

An abstract geometric pattern on a teal background, featuring various magenta shapes including circles, triangles, lines, and arcs. The pattern is dense and covers the lower two-thirds of the page.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE QUEEN'S
MATRIMONIAL LADDER ***

THE QUEEN'S MATRIMONIAL LADDER

A National Toy

**With Fourteen Step Scenes; and Illustrations in
Verse,**

By William Hone

The Author of "The Political House That Jack Built"

With Eighteen other Cuts

Illustrated by GEORGE CRUIKSHANK

*"The question is not merely
whether the Queen shall have
her*

*rights, but whether the
rights of an individual in the
kingdom shall be free
from violation."*

*Her Majesty's Answer to the
Norwich Address.*

*"Here is a Gentleman, and a
friend of mine!"*

*Measure
for Measure.*

Twenty-First Edition.

London:

Printed by and for William Hone, Ludgate-Hill.

1820.

This Pamphlet and the Toy together,

One Shilling.

**THE QUEEN'S
MATRIMONIAL LADDER,**

A National Toy,
WITH FOURTEEN STEP SCENES;
AND
ILLUSTRATIONS IN VERSE,
WITH EIGHTEEN OTHER CUTS.

BY THE AUTHOR OF "THE POLITICAL HOUSE THAT
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1820.

This Pamphlet and the Toy together,
ONE SHILLING.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

"It is a wonderful thing to
consider the strength of
Princes' wills when they are
bent to have their Pleasure

fulfilled, wherein no
reasonable persuasions will
serve

their turn: how little do they
regard the dangerous sequels,

that ensue as well as to
themselves as to their Subjects.

And amongst all things there
is nothing that makes them

more wilful than Carnal
Love, and various affecting of
Voluptuous desires."

*Cavendish's Memoirs of
Card. Wolsey.*



[Original Size](#) -- [Medium-Size](#)

CONTENTS

[QUALIFICATION.](#)

[DECLARATION.](#)

[ACCEPTATION.](#)

[ALTERATION.](#)

[IMPUTATION.](#)

[EXCULPATION.](#)

[EMIGRATION.](#)

[REMIGRATION.](#)

CONSTERNATION.

ACCUSATION.

PUBLICATION.

INDIGNATION

CORONATION.

DEGRADATION.

THE JOSS AND HIS FOLLY,

QUALIFICATION.

In love, and in drink, and o'ertopped by debt;
With women, with wine, and with duns on the
fret.



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DECLARATION.

The Prodigal Son, by his perils surrounded,
Vex'd, harass'd, bewilder'd, asham'd, and
confounded,

Fled for help to his Father,
confessed his ill doing,

And begged for salvation
from stark staring ruin;

The sire urged—"The People
your debts have twice paid,

And, to ask a third time,
even Pitt is afraid;

"But he shall if you'll marry, and lead a new life,

—

"You've a cousin in Germany—make her your
wife!"



Lured from her own, her native home,
The home of early life,
And doom'd in stranger realms to roam;
A widow! yet a wife!

Phillips's Lament.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

ACCEPTATION.

From the high halls of Brunswick, all youthful and
 gay,
From the hearth of her fathers, he lured her away:
How joy'd she in coming—
 how smiling the bower;
How sparkling their nuptials—
 how welcome her dower.

Ah! short were her pleasures—full soon came her
 cares—
Her husbandless bride-bed was wash'd with her
 tears.



The most desolate woman in the world!
Thy daughter, then, could hear thee weep;
But now she sleeps the dreamless sleep.

Phillips's Lament.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

ALTERATION.

Near a million of debts gone,
all gone were her charms—
What! an Epicure have his own wife
in his arms?

She was not to his taste—
what car'd *he* for the 'form,'
'To love and to cherish'
could not mean reform:

'To love' meant, of course, nothing else
but neglect
'To cherish' to leave her,
and shew disrespect.



-----fed appetite resign'd
The victim up to shame.
Phillips's Lament.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

IMPUTATION.

Was it manly, when widow'd,
to spy at her actions;
"To listen to eaves-droppers,
whisp'ring detractions;

And, like an old Watchman,
with faults to conceal,
Get up a *false Charge*,
as a proof of his zeal?

If desertion was base, Oh base be his name,
Who, having deserted, would bring her to
shame!



God, and your Majesty, protect mine innocence!
King Henry VIII.

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EXCULPATION.

Undaunted in spirit, her courage arose,
With encrease of charges, and encrease of foes.
Despising the husband,
 who thus had abused her,
She proved to his father,
 his son had ill used her:—

Her conduct examin'd, and sifted, shone bright,
Her enemies fled, as the shadows of night.

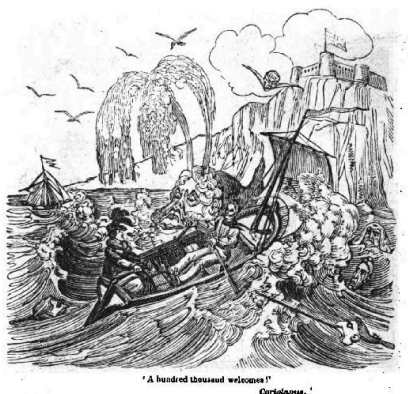


— A wanderer, far away,
Neglected and reviled—
Philip's Lament.

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EMIGRATION.

Her father and king, while with reason yet blest,
Protected her weakness, and shielded her rest;
Infirmity seizes him, false friends draw near,
Then spies gather round, and malignants appear;
And cajole, wait, watch, insult,
 alarm, and betray,
Till from home, and her daughter,
 they force her away.



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REMIGRATION.

Still pursued, when a 'wanderer,'
her child sleeps in death,
And her best friend, in England, her king,
yields his breath;

This gives her new rights—
they neglect and proscribe her;
She threatens returning—they then try to bribe
her!

The bullies turn slaves, and, in meanness, fawn on
her:

They feel her contempt, and they vow her
dishonour;

But she 'steers her own course,' comes indignantly
over,

And the shouts of the nation salute her at Dover!



He smelt—O Lord! how he did smelt!
Southey's *Minor Poems*, vol. iii. p. 106.

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CONSTERNATION.

Ah, what was that groan!—
 'twas the Head of the Church,
When he found she was come—
 for he dreaded a search
Into what *he*'d been doing:
 and sorely afraid, for
What *she* might find out,
 cried '*I'll not have her pray'd for*';
And the B——ps, obeying their *pious* Head,
 care took
That the name of his wife
 should be out of the prayer book!



—— I will kill thee, if thou dost deny
Thou hast made me a cuckold.

—— What false Italian
(As poisonous tongue as handed) hath prevailed
On thy too ready hearing?

Cymbeline.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

ACCUSATION.

On searching for precedents, much to their dread,
They found that they could n't well cut off her
head;

And the 'House of Incurables' raised a 'Report'
She was not a fit person to live in *his* Court.

How like an OLD CHARLEY
they then made him stand,
In his lanthorn a *leech*,
the 'Report' in his hand.

'Good folks be so good as not go near that door
'For, though my own wife, she *is*—I could say
more

'But it's all in this *Bag*, and there'll be a fine
pothor,

'I shall get rid of her, and I'll then get another!'

Yet he thought, to himself,—

'twas a thought most distressing,—
'If *she* should discover
I've been M—ch—ss—g,
'There's an end of the whole!
D—rs C—ns, of course,
'If *my own* hands are dirty,
won't grant a D——ce!'

He tried to look wise, but he only look'd wild;
The women laugh'd out, and the grave even
smiled;
The old frown'd upon him—the children made
sport,
And his wife held her *ridicule* at his 'Report'!

MORAL.

*Be warn'd, by his fate
Married, single, and all;
Ye elderly Gentlemen,
Pity his fall!*



Give me but the Liberty of the Press, and I will give to the minister a verbal
House of Peers. Aberdeen.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

PUBLICATION.

As yon bright orb, that vivifies our ball,
Sees through our system, and illumines all;

So, sees and shines, our *Moral* Sun, *The Press*,
Alike to vivify the mind, and bless;

Sees the rat *Leech* turn towards Milan's walls,

'Till the black slime betrays him as he crawls;
Sees, from that recreant, vile, and eunuch-land,
Where felon-perjurers hold their market-stand,
Cooke, with his 'cheek of parchment, eye of
stone,'

Get up the evidence, to go well down;

Sees who, with eager hands, the Green Bag cram,
And warns the nation of the frightful flam;

Sees Him, for whom they work the treacherous
task,

With face, scarce half conceal'd, behind their
mask.

Fat, fifty-eight, and frisky, still a beau,

Grasping a half-made match; by *Leech*-light go;
Led by a passion, prurient, blind, and letter'd,
Lame, bloated, pointless, flameless, age'd and
shatter'd;

Creeping, like Guy Fawkes, to blow up his wife,
Whom, spurn'd in youth, he dogs through after-
life.

Scorn'd, exiled, baffled, goaded in distress,

She owes her safety to a fearless Press:

With all the freedom that it makes its own,

It guards, alike, the people and their throne;

While fools with darkling eye-balls shun its gaze,
And soaring villains scorch beneath its blaze.



I am wrapp'd in dismal thoughts! -
THE KING, in life's world that ends with.

Original Size -- Medium-Size

INDIGNATION

The day will soon come, when the Judge and the
Ponderer,'

Will judge between thee, and the charge-daring

'Wanderer;'

Will say—"Thou who cast the first stone at thy
wife,

Art thou without sin, and is spotless *thy* life?'

Ah! what if *thy* faults should 'outrival the sloe,'
And thy wife's, beside thine, should look 'whiter
than snow'!

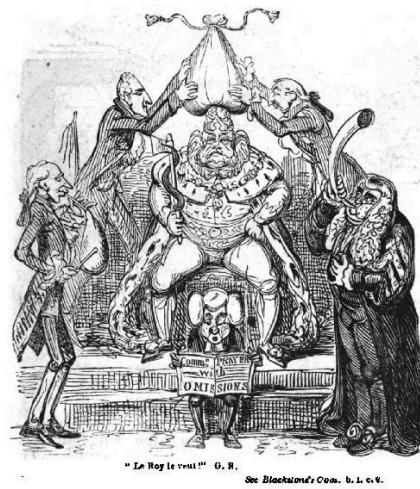
Bethink thee! the old British Lion awoke,

Turns indignant, and treads out thy bag-full of
smoke.

Spurn thy minions—the traitors, who counsel
thee,

banish;

And the soldiers will quickly forget all their
Spanish!



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CORONATION.

Shakspeare says, in King John, it's a curse most
abhorrent,

That '*Slaves* take the humours of Kings for a
warrant.'

A more *useful* truth never fell from his pen,

If Kings would apply it like sober-bred men.

The Slaves of *your* will,
will make your reign, in History,

A misrule of force, folly, taxing, and mystery:
Indulging your wish for
what, with law, 's incompatible,

For the present, they've render'd your crown
not come-at-able;

And the tongues of old women and infancy wag,

With, 'He call'd for his crown—and
they gave him the *Bag!*'



Original Size -- Medium-Size

DEGRADATION.

To this have they brought thee, at last!

Exposed thee, for all men to see!
Ah, surely, their pandering
 shall quickly be past:
'How wretched their portion
shall be!

Derision shall strike them
 forlorn,

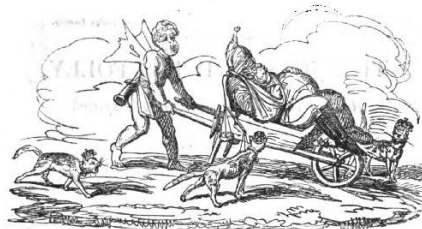
'A mockery that never shall die:

'The curses of hate and the hisses
 of scorn,

'Shall follow wherever they fly;
'And proud o'er their ruin
 for ever be hurl'd,

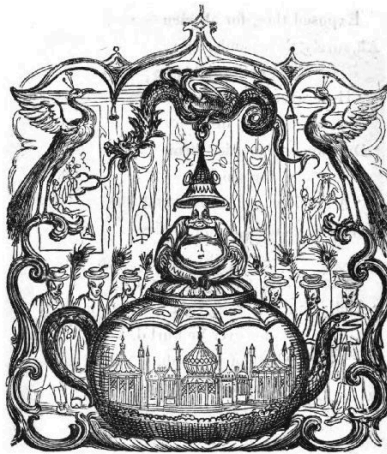
'The laughter of triumph,
the jeers of the world!'

THE END



"Cet's Men!"
English Cry.

[Original Size](#) -- [Medium-Size](#)



I say, HUM, how fares it with Royalty now?
Is it up?—Is it prime?—Is it spunky?—or how?
The Judge Family.

[Original Size](#) -- [Medium-Size](#)

THE JOSS AND HIS FOLLY,

An Extract of an overland, Dispatch.

I stare at it from out my casement,

And ask for what is such a place meant.

Byron.

July 29, 1820.

—The queerest of all the queer sights

I've set sight on;—

Is, the *what d'ye-call-t thing*, here,

THE FOLLY at Brighton

The outside—huge teapots,
 all drill'd round with holes,
Relieved by extinguishers,
 sticking on poles:
The inside—all tea-things,
 and dragons, and bells, t
The show rooms—*all* show,
 the sleeping rooms—cells.

But the *grand* Curiosity
 's not to be seen—
The owner himself—
 an old fat *Mandarin*;
A patron of painters
 who copy designs,
That grocers and tea-dealers
 hang up for signs:
Hence teaboard-taste artists
 gain rewards and distinction,
Hence his title of '*Teapot*'
 shall last to extinction.

I saw his great chair
 into which he falls—soss—
And sits, in his *China Shop*,
 like a large Joss;
His mannikins round him,
 in tea-tray array,
His pea-hens beside him,
 to make him seem gay.

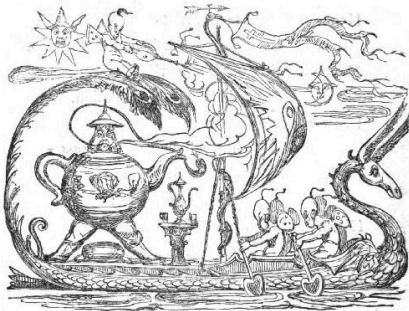
It is said when he sleeps
 on his state Eider-down,
And thinks on his Wife,
 and about *half* a Crown;
That he wakes from these horrible dreams
 in a stew;
And that, stretching his arms out,
 he screams, Mrs. Q!

He's cool'd on the M—ch-ss,
 but I'm your debtor
For further particulars—
 in a C letter.

You must know that he hates *his own* wife,
to a failing;—

And it 's thought, it's to shun her,
he's now gone out

SAILING.



A firing tripod stands, one arm held out,
One test ; the handle this, and that the spoon.
Hope of the Lock.

FINIS.

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Finis.

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MATRIMONIAL LADDER ***

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THE QUEEN'S ATRIMONIAL LADDER,

A National Toy,
WITH FOURTEEN STEP SCENES;
AND
ILLUSTRATIONS IN VERSE,
WITH EIGHTEEN OTHER CUTS.

BY THE AUTHOR OF "THE POLITICAL HOUSE THAT
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The question is not merely whether the Queen shall have her rights, but whether the rights
of any individual in the kingdom shall be free from violation."

Her Majesty's Answer to the Norwich Address.



"Here is a Gentleman, and a friend of mine!"

Measure for Measure.

Twenty-first Edition.

LONDON:
PRINTED BY AND FOR WILLIAM HONE, LUDGATE-HILL.

1820.

This Pamphlet and the Toy together,
ONE SHILLING.

[back](#)

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Give not thy strength unto women, nor thy ways to that which destroyeth kings.

Solomon.

[back](#)



Give not thy strength unto women, nor thy ways to that which destroyeth kings.

Solomon.

[back](#)



Penury incurr'd
By endless riot, vanity ; the lust
Of pleasure and variety !———.
———Ministerial grace
Deals him out money from the public chest.

Cowper.

[back](#)



Penury incurr'd
By endless riot, vanity ; the lust
Of pleasure and variety !———.
———Ministerial grace
Deals him out money from the public chest.

Copper.

[back](#)



Lured from her own, her native home,
The home of early life,
And doom'd in stranger realms to roam;
A widow ! yet a wife !

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



Lured from her own, her native home,
The home of early life,
And doom'd in stranger realms to roam;
A widow ! yet a wife !

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



The most desolate woman in the world!

**Thy daughter, *then*, could hear thee weep ;
But now she sleeps the dreamless sleep.**

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



The most desolate woman in the world!

**Thy daughter, *then*, could hear thee weep ;
But now she sleeps the dreamless sleep.**

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



—————faded appetite resign'd
The victim up to shame.

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



-----faded appetite resign'd
The victim up to shame.

Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



God, and your Majesty, protect mine innocence !

King Henry VIII.

[back](#)



God, and your Majesty, protect mine innocence !

King Henry VIII.

[back](#)



— — — A wanderer, far away,
Neglected and reviled —
Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



— — — A wanderer, far away,
Neglected and reviled —
Phillips's Lament.

[back](#)



'A hundred thousand welcomes!'

Coriolanus.

[back](#)



'A hundred thousand welcomes!'

Coriolanus.

[back](#)



He smelt—O Lord! how he did smell!

Southey's Minor Poems, vol. iii. p. 108.

[back](#)



He smelt—O Lord! how he did smell!

Southey's Minor Poems, vol. iii. p. 108.

[back](#)

“——— A BURNING SHAME!”



——— I will kill thee, if thou dost deny
Thou hast made me a cuckold.

————— What false Italian
(As poisonous tongued as handed) hath prevailed
On thy too ready hearing?

Cymbeline.

[back](#)

"——— A BURNING SHAME!"



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Cymbeline.

[back](#)



Give me but the Liberty of the Press, and I will give to the minister a venal
House of Peers. *Sheridan.*

[back](#)



Give me but the Liberty of the Press, and I will give to the minister a venal
House of Peers. *Sheridan.*

[back](#)



I am wrapp'd in dismal thinkings!—

THE KING, in *All's well that ends well*.

[back](#)



I am wrapp'd in dismal thinkings!—

THE KING, in *All's well that ends well*.

[back](#)



"Le Roy le veut!" G. R.

See Blackstone's Com. b. 1. c. 2.

[back](#)



"Le Roy le veut!" G. R.

See Blackstone's Com. b. 1. c. 2.

[back](#)



So let him stand

Byron.

[back](#)



So let him stand

Byron.

[back](#)



"Cats' Meat!"

English Cry.

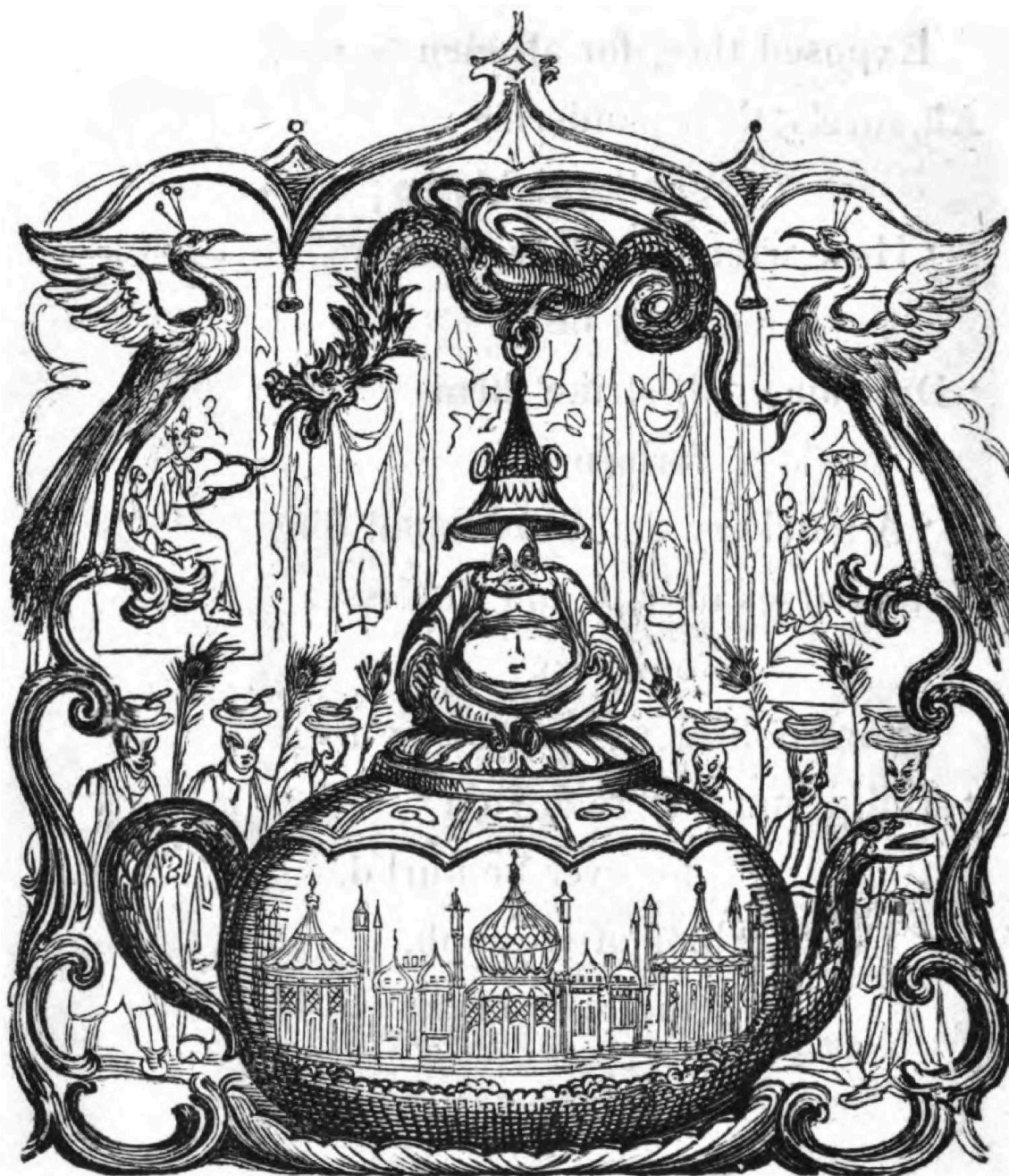
[back](#)



"Cats' Meat!"

English Cry.

[back](#)



I say, HUM, how fares it with Royalty now?
Is it up?—Is it *prime*?—Is it *spooney*?—or how?

The Fudge Family.

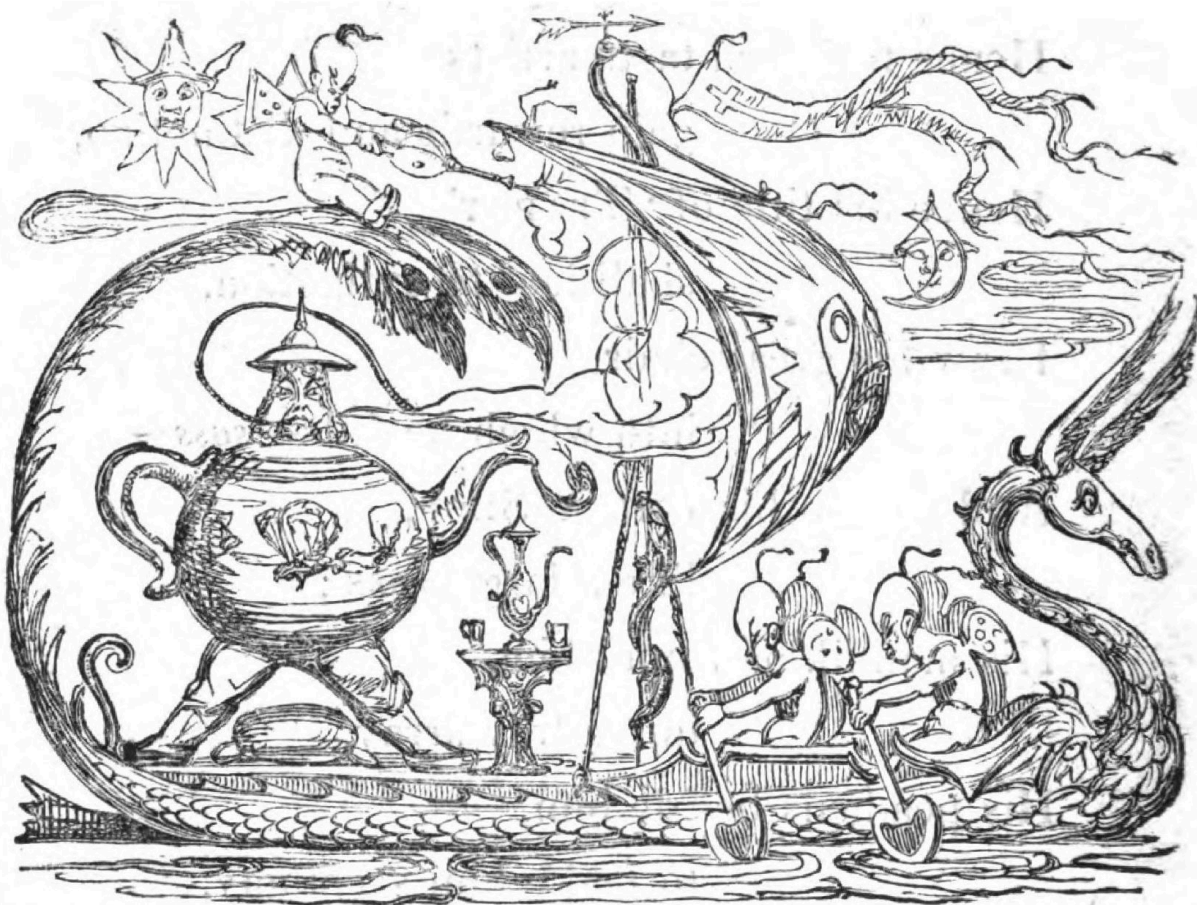
[back](#)



I say, HUM, how fares it with Royalty now?
Is it up?—Is it *prime*?—Is it *spooney*?—or how?

The Fudge Family.

[back](#)



A living teapot stands, one arm held out,
One bent ; the handle this, and that the spout.

Rape of the Lock.

FINIS.

[back](#)



A living teapot stands, one arm held out,
One bent ; the huddle this, and that the spout.

Rope of the Lock.

FINIS.

[back](#)